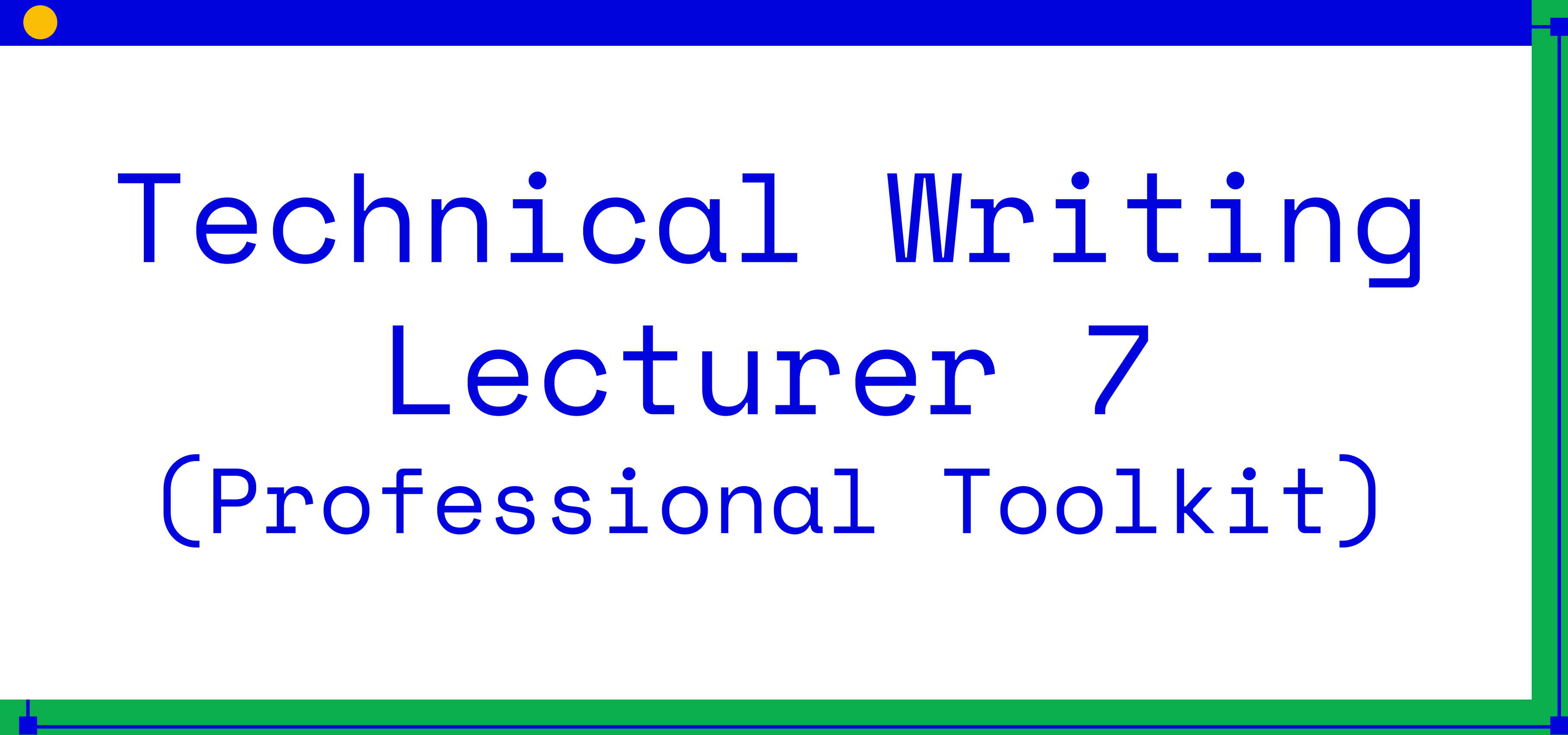




Technical Writing

Lecturer 7

(Professional Toolkit)

Agenda: Mastering Technical Presentations

1. Professional Communication
2. Pitching Your Tech Ideas
3. Progress Reports
4. Questions



Professional Communication

Netiquette (The "Rules" of the Internet)

- **Privacy is a Myth:** Never write anything in an email or message that you wouldn't want the Dean or your Future Boss to see
- **Don't "Shout":** Writing in ALL CAPS is considered shouting and is very unprofessional
- **Stay Secure:** As AI/CS students, you should know better than to click suspicious links or share passwords via email.

Texting and Instant Messaging

- **When to use it:**

- For quick questions ("Is the lab in Room 302?") or urgent updates

- **The "Pro" Tip:**

- Avoid using too many emojis or "SMS language" when talking to instructors
 - Example of SMS language: like "u" instead of "you"
- Keep it clear and concise

Emails

- **The Subject Line:** Be specific.
 - Bad: "Help!!"
 - Good: "Question: Logic Design Assignment 2 - Section 4"
- **The Salutation:**
 - Start with "Dear Dr. [Name]" or "Hello Engineer [Name]"
- **The Body:** Get straight to the point.
 - If you are reporting a problem with a server or a project, describe it clearly
- **The Closing:** Use "Best regards" or "Sincerely," followed by your full name and Academic ID.

Emails (Example)

<i>To:</i>	dr_ahmed@bu.edu.eg
<i>Subject:</i>	Absence Request - Programming 1 Lecture (Feb 25)
<i>Body:</i>	Dear Dr. Ahmed, I hope you are well. I am writing to inform you that I will be unable to attend the lecture this Tuesday due to a medical appointment. I will watch the recorded session and submit the lab task on time. Best regards, Omar Ali (ID: 20240012)

Memos (Internal Communication)

- **Format:** They usually include headers for
 - "TO:"
 - "FROM:"
 - "DATE:"
 - "SUBJECT:"
- **Goal:** To announce changes, like
 - a new deadline for the AI competition or
 - a change in the lab schedule

Professional Letters (Formal & External)

- **Usage :**

- Formal job offers
- recommendation requests
- official complaints

- **Tone:** Very respectful and structured

- Unlike an email, a letter usually includes the sender's and receiver's physical addresses

Summary

Type	Best For	Tone
Text/DM	Quick updates with teammates	Casual but polite
Email	Contacting professors or HR	Professional
Memo	Announcements within the faculty or the company	Direct and factual
Letter	Official applications or legal matters	Highly formal

A graphic of a white rectangular window with a green title bar and a green border. A blue circle is in the top-left corner of the title bar. The text "Pitching Your Tech Ideas" is centered in the window in a blue, monospace-style font.

Pitching Your Tech Ideas

What is a Proposal?

- **A "sales pitch" in writing**
- You aren't just saying "I want to build an app"; you are proving that:
 - There is a problem that needs to be solved.
 - You have a technical solution.
 - You have a plan (time and tools) to get it done.

Types of Proposals

- **Solicited:**

- Like when a professor asks for project ideas for a course
- They provide the "Request for Proposals" (RFP)

- **Unsolicited:**

- Like when you notice a bug in the university's registration system and write a proposal to the IT department to fix it without them asking first

The Structure of a Tech Proposal (1/2)

- **Introduction:** Clearly state what you are proposing
 - Example: "We propose developing an AI-powered chatbot for the Benha University website to help freshmen find their lecture halls"
- **Problem Statement** (The "Why")
 - Example: "Currently, new students get lost during the first week, leading to crowded hallways and missed lectures"
- **Proposed Solution** (The "How")
 - Example: "Using Python and the Gemini API, we will create a mobile-friendly interface..."

The Structure of a Tech Proposal (2/2)

- **Schedule and Budget**

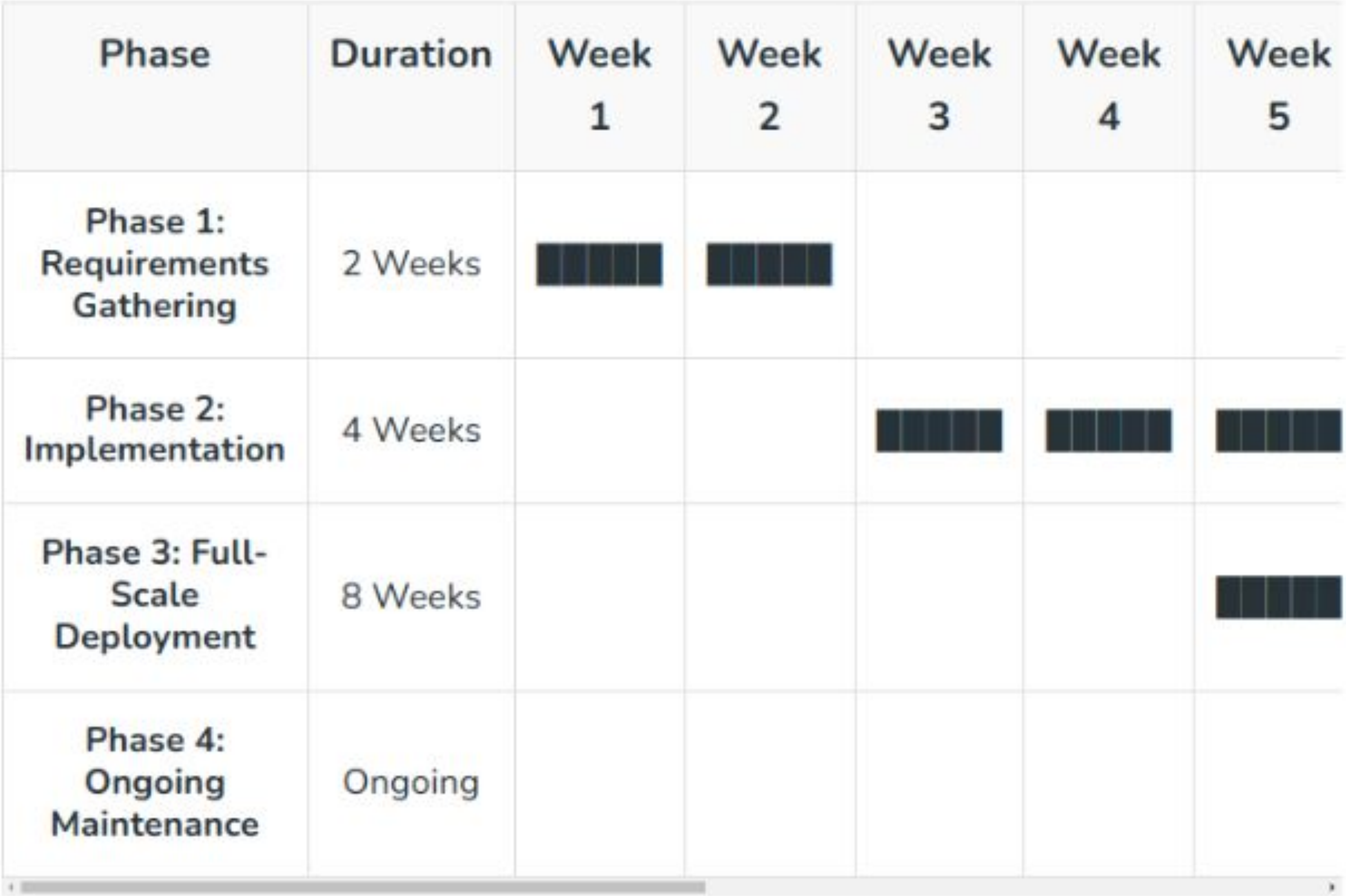
- **Timeline:** Use a "Gantt Chart" or a simple list showing when coding starts and when testing ends

- **Resources:** Mention if you need a specific server, a GPU for training your AI model, or just a free GitHub account

- **Conclusion/Call to Action**

- Briefly remind the reader of the benefits and ask for approval

Gantt Chart



Professional "Pro" Tips for Proposals

- **Be Specific:**

- Don't just say "We will use AI"
- Say "We will use Convolutional Neural Networks (CNN) for image recognition"

- **Focus on Benefits:**

- Don't just talk about the code; talk about how it helps the user

- **Proofread:**

- As a CS student, you know that a missing semicolon breaks code
- One big typo in a proposal can break your professional image!

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Progress Reports

Why Do We Write Progress Reports?

- Imagine you are working on a team project to build a mobile app
- Your professor needs to know:
 - Is the team actually working, or are you stuck?
 - Have you finished the Database design yet?
 - What problems are you facing (e.g., a bug you can't fix)?
 - Will you finish by the deadline?

Main Parts of a Progress Report

- Work Accomplished (**The Past**): Be specific!
 - **Bad**: "We wrote some code"
 - **Good**: "Finished the Login Page UI and connected it to the Firebase authentication"
- Work in Progress & Problems (**The Present**)
 - **Example**: "We are currently training the AI model. However, we are facing an issue with slow training times because the lab computers need more RAM"
- Future Work (**The Future**)
 - **Example**: "Next week, we plan to start the 'User Profile' section and begin Beta testing with 5 students."

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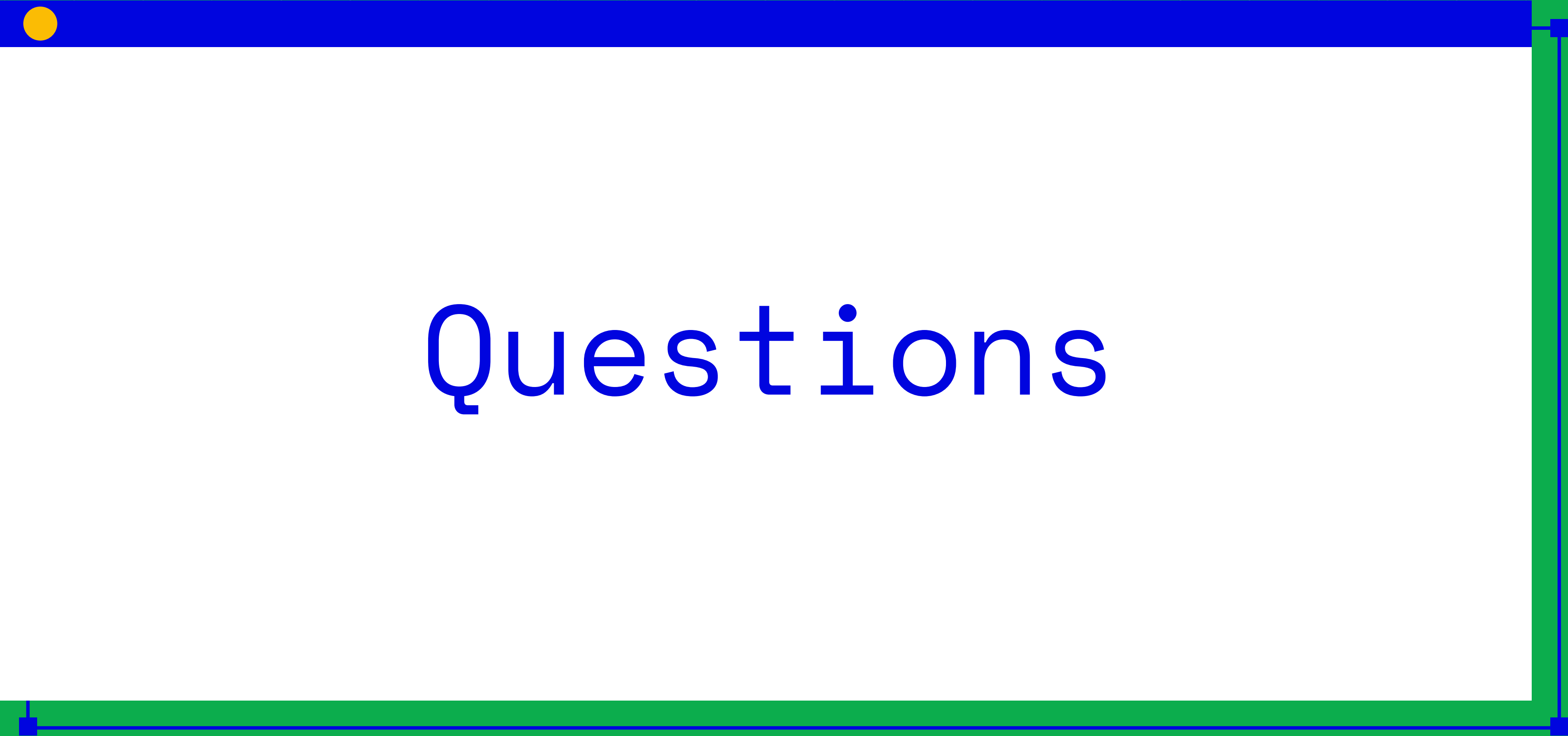
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Common Formats for CS Students

- **Email Progress Report:** Most common for weekly updates, such as to a Teaching Assistant (TA)
- **Memo:** Used if you are reporting to a student club or a formal department head
- **Formal Report:** Usually required for term reviews of your Graduation Project

Professional Tips for BFCAI Students

- **Be Honest about Bugs:** If your code isn't working, say so
 - It's better to ask for help now than to fail the demo later
- **Use Lists:** Professors have many students
 - Use bullet points so they can scan your report in 30 seconds
- **Update the Schedule:**
 - If you realized that the "Database" part is taking two weeks instead of one, update your timeline in the report (the Gantt Chart).



Questions